

Discuss the Nursing Assistant role in the use of bandages, binders and dressings.

A. Purpose of bandages and binders

1. Apply pressure (compression) in order to stop bleeding or swelling, and to assist in absorbing tissue fluids
2. Provide for immobilization of an injured part; a fractured (broken) arm
3. Hold dressings in place
4. Protect open wounds from contaminants
5. Apply warmth to a joint, as for persons suffering from painful joints due to arthritis
6. Provide support and aid in venous (return blood flow) circulation, as when bandaging the leg of a patient/resident suffering from varicose veins or limited circulation in the extremities (arms or legs)

B. Dressings are ordered by the physician and initially applied by the licensed nurse

C. Nurse Assistant role

1. Apply simple, dry, non-sterile dressings to uncomplicated wounds
2. Assist the licensed nurse with complex wounds

Discuss the Nursing Assistant role in the use of bandages, binders and dressings.

D. The licensed nurse will inform the Nurse Assistant when to change a dressing and what supplies to use

E. Materials used for dressings and bandages

1. Dressings are made from a variety of materials, mainly gauze which comes in 2 inch, 3 inch, and 4 inch squares. The size depends on the area of the body involved and the purpose of the dressing
2. Bandages and binders are made from muslin, gauze, flannel, rubber, and elastic fiber
3. Dressings are held in place with hypoallergenic tape, plastic tape, elastic tape, paper tape, silk tape, adhesive tape, and binders or bandages. The type depends on the purpose and the patient/resident

F. Principles of bandaging

1. Apply bandage so pressure is evenly distributed to area
 - a. If joint is involved in bandaging, support it in a comfortable position with a slight flexion of the joint
 - b. Attach bandage securely to avoid friction and rubbing of underlying tissue which could cause irritation
 - c. Start at the lower (distal) part of extremity
 - d. Work upward to the top (proximal) part

Discuss the Nursing Assistant role in the use of bandages, binders and dressings.

G. Rationale for removing elastic bandages

1. Elastic bandages should be removed every eight hours, unless ordered more frequently, to allow for inspection of underlying skin
2. Replace a moist or soiled bandage
3. Reapply a loose or wrinkled bandage

H. Observation and reporting to licensed nurse

1. Swelling
2. Pain
3. Change in color
4. Decrease or increase of temperature
5. Drainage: color, consistency, amount
6. Odor

Describe the use and method of applying anti-embolic hose/elastic stockings.

A. Anti-embolic hose/elastic stockings are used to increase circulation by improving venous return from the legs to the heart

B. Key points when applying elastic stockings

1. Always apply before patient/resident gets out of bed
2. Check for wrinkles
3. Check skin color and temperature
4. Check popliteal pulse

C. Anti-embolic hose/elastic stockings are to be removed every 8 hrs. or according to facility policy

Identify the Nurse Assistant's role in the care of patient's/resident's skin conditions and the use of non-legend topical ointments, lotions, or powders.

A. The Nurse Assistant can provide care to patients/residents with the following intact skin conditions

1. Foot care
2. Dandruff
3. Dry Skin

B. The Nurse Assistant must reports the following existing skin conditions to the licensed nurse

1. Acne
2. Minor burn
3. Rash
4. Excoriation, abrasions, skin tears
5. Eczema or psoriasis
6. Poison ivy or poison oak
7. Minor wounds
8. Insect bites or stings

Identify the Nurse Assistant's role in the care of patient's/resident's skin conditions and the use of non-legend topical ointments, lotions, or powders.

C. The Nurse Assistant can apply over-the-counter ointments, lotions, or powders to intact skin surface only

D. The Nurse Assistant does not apply ointments, lotions, or powders to irritated skin surfaces OR open lesions

E. Over-the-counter ointments, lotions, or powders that the Nurse Assistant may apply to intact skin

1. Zinc oxide
2. A and D ointment
3. Clearasil
4. Stri-dex medicated pads
5. Selsun Blue
6. Keri Lotion
7. Corn Huskers
8. Johnson's Medicated Powder
9. Tinactin Foot Powder

Identify the Nurse Assistant's role in the care of patient's/resident's skin conditions and the use of non-legend topical ointments, lotions, or powders.

F. General rules for application of ointment, lotion, or powder

1. Prepare the patient/resident
2. Position the patient/resident
3. Cleanse the skin
4. Protect the surrounding skin
5. Applying ointments, lotions, or powders
 - a. Apply as directed, wear gloves
 - b. Creams or liniments are rubbed in by hand
 - c. Lotions are patted on with a cotton ball
 - d. Ointments are applied with a wooden tongue blade or a cotton swab
 - e. Sprinkle powder onto hand or cloth, and then apply to patient/resident
6. Chart and report observations
 - a. Make a note of the appearance of the skin
 - b. Describe any changes in the appearance
 - c. Identify any signs of irritation

Explain the role of the Nurse Assistant in the admission of a patient/resident to the facility.

A. Admission to a long-term facility is stressful to both the patient/resident and family

1. First impressions of the facility are important for the adjustment of the patient/resident to the facility
2. The new patient/resident may have many feelings of loss
 - a. Home
 - b. Possessions
 - c. Independence
 - d. Family
 - e. Freedom
 - f. Privacy
 - g. Control over one's life

Explain the role of the Nurse Assistant in the admission of a patient/resident to the facility.

B. Welcome the patient/resident

1. Greet patient/resident by name
2. Introduce yourself
3. Explain what you will be doing
4. Convey a warm welcome through tone of voice and facial expression

C. Collect base line information about the patient/resident

1. Measure patient's/resident's height and weight
2. Measure patient's/resident's vital signs
3. Observe the patient's/resident's
 - a. Grooming
 - b. Condition of hair and nails
 - c. Condition of skin
 - d. Mental alertness
 - e. Sight and hearing
 - f. Presence of any prosthesis
 - g. Ability to move around

Explain the role of the Nurse Assistant in the admission of a patient/resident to the facility.

D. Report all questions and concerns of the patient/resident or family to the licensed nurse

E. Orient the patient/resident and family to the facility

1. Review facility routine
2. Introduce patient/resident to roommate and staff
3. Tour the facility
4. Explain the operation of bed controls, TV controls, and nurse call system

F. Care for personal belongings

1. Patients/residents must know they have control over their possessions and can decide where to put item
2. Fill out the facility list of possessions
 - a. Encourage patient/resident to send valuables home with family
 - b. Objectively describe valuables kept at facility
3. Label items with patients/residents' name



Explain the role of the Nurse Assistant in transferring a patient/resident from one area to another within the facility.

A. Tell the patient/resident in advance about the transfer, and explain the reason for moving

B. Collect all the patient's/resident's belongings and take them to the new room

1. Be careful not to lose any items
2. Check all drawers and closets for personal items

C. Introduce patient/resident to new roommates

1. New surroundings may cause confusion; orient patient/resident to new room
2. Continue to remind patient/resident of new room

Explain the role of the Nurse Assistant in the discharge of a patient/resident.

A. Collect base line information about the patient/resident:

1. Measure patient's/resident's height and weight
2. Measure patient's/resident's vital signs
3. Observe the patient's/resident's:
 - a. Grooming
 - b. Condition of hair and nails
 - c. Condition of skin
 - d. Mental alertness
 - e. Sight and hearing
 - f. Presence of any prosthesis
 - g. Ability to move around

B. Collect all personal belongings of the patient/resident:

1. Check all drawers and closets for personal items
2. Review facility list of possessions for items that might be in the safe or locked cabinet or the laundry

C. Assist the patient/resident to his or her vehicle or designated mode of transportation after checking with licensed nurse.
Patient/resident usually leaves by wheelchair